



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Kenya: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-17 · 184 systems and instruments tracked, 6 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-17 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 184 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 93 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-17, 24 did not, 61 carry no stated baseline, and 6 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 487 sources for this place in the window — 71 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 416 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

Over the twelve months, Kenya's regulatory layer went from empty to fully drafted in two areas that had no instrument at all — artificial intelligence and virtual assets — while the state's own digital spending fell for a second consecutive year. The shape check above records how uneven the base is; the comparison rests mostly on its later half, and rows whose only source is recent but which describe long-standing systems carry their position from earlier rather than as movement.

## Infrastructure

### Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Communications Equipment Distributor licence | Did not exist                                                                | Mandatory before equipment type approval and TradeNet clearance; KSh 1m or three years for non-compliance                              | ADVANCED |
| LINX Nairobi internet exchange               | Operating; peer count not held and combined traffic one-twentieth of current | 55-plus connected networks including TikTok and Starlink; combined Nairobi and Mombasa exchange traffic 330 Gbps, twentyfold in a year | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                                      | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT              |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Safaricom 25-year unified licence</b>              | Temporary two-year unified permit, historic term ten years         | 25-year unified licence consolidating spectrum and authorisations; licence-related costs about US\$126.7m in the year to March 2026                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED              |
| <b>Starlink Direct-to-Cell with Airtel Kenya</b>      | No direct satellite-to-handset service in Kenya                    | Pilot reported successful; would be Kenya's first direct-to-cell service on compatible handsets with no extra SIM or charge, conditional on CA approval                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED              |
| <b>Starlink Kenya fixed broadband</b>                 | 17,425 subscribers and 0.8% fixed share, 359 net adds Apr-Jun 2025 | 24,999 subscribers and 0.9% share, top-ten fixed ISP (Mar 2026); median speed 34.55 Mbps, down 26% year on year; orders in seven counties diverted to a deposit-backed waitlist                                                                                                               | ADVANCED, THEN CAPPED |
| <b>Africa-1 subsea cable</b>                          | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                  | 10,000km France to Middle East system routed through Africa, which TeleGeography expects to land in Kenya in 2027, taking Kenya from seven landings to nine                                                                                                                                   | Baseline not held     |
| <b>Digital Superhighway fibre and hotspot targets</b> | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                  | 100,000km of fibre and 25,000 public Wi-Fi hotspots targeted; the regulator reports 2,193km deployed under phase one and 1,173 last-mile sites connected under phase two at 30 June 2025; FY2026/27 carries KSh 1.3bn for backbone maintenance and KSh 528m for last-mile county connectivity | Baseline not held     |
| <b>Kenya-Tanzania Terrestrial Fibre Link</b>          | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                  | Cross-border link integrating Tanzania's NICTBB with the Mombasa submarine landings, delivered by the ICT Authority with Tanzania Telecommunications Corporation                                                                                                                              | Baseline not held     |
| <b>Meta Daraja subsea cable</b>                       | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                  | 4,108km, 24 fibre pairs, Salalah to Mombasa, US\$23m, ready for service 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Baseline not held     |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                              | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Airtel Nxtra data centre, Tatu City</b>        | Announced 44MW at Tatu City, ground not yet broken                                                         | 44MW in two phases, US\$150m, dedicated 135 MVA substation in the Tatu City special economic zone with on-site solar                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED, SLIPPED                         |
| <b>Baobab Cloud sovereign public cloud</b>        | Did not exist                                                                                              | Shilling billing, zero egress, 99.9% service level and in-country data residency, hosted at iXAfrica NBOX1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED                                  |
| <b>iXAfrica NBOX1 campus</b>                      | Operating, 17,300 square metres, expansion unfunded                                                        | 22.5MW target capacity; anchor site for the Oracle Nairobi region, TouchNet, Servernah, Baobab and the Qubit Hub AI lab, with 11 acres bought for a second Nairobi campus                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED                                  |
| <b>Konza National Data Centre</b>                 | KSh 3.1bn appropriated for Konza data centre and smart city in FY2025/26, down from KSh 5.2bn in FY2024/25 | 706 kW certified IT capacity against an actual load of about 300 kW, 144 racks with 100 in use, Tier III Design and Construction certified and hosting 145 of 451 government institutions (2026-04-13); expansion to 288 racks and 1 to 2 MW being structured as a public-private partnership, with no Konza data-centre allocation disclosed at FY2026/27 budget day | REGRESSED, EXPANSION MOVED TO A PPP ROUTE |
| <b>Microsoft-G42 Olkaria data centre</b>          | US\$1bn, 100MW initial geothermal build targeting a May 2026 launch with an East Africa cloud region       | No ground broken and the May 2026 target passed; Microsoft and G42 asked Kenya to guarantee annual uptake of capacity, including by neighbouring countries, and the government declined, while the ICT principal secretary said on 2026-05-12 that the talks had not collapsed and the project was "not failed or withdrawn"                                          | STALLED                                   |
| <b>Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Nairobi region</b> | Announced January 2024, no colocation partner, site or date named                                          | iXAfrica NBOX1 confirmed as host, more than 20MW IT capacity when fully built and up to 50 kW per rack; still listed as coming soon                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED                                  |
| <b>TouchNet Zadara AI Sovereign Cloud</b>         | GPU-as-a-service sovereign AI cloud at iXAfrica NBOX1                                                      | Unchanged; nothing held records capacity, customers or expansion since launch                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE                                 |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Konza local cloud outpost and startup centre | Baseline not held        | The technopolis authority and a hyperscaler are exploring a local cloud outpost and a startup and technical centre of excellence, aimed at data residency and low-latency hybrid cloud and at giving Kenyan startups credits, mentorship and partner-network access; no agreement, capacity, site, investment figure or date is stated | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| Olkaria EcoCloud data centre                 | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Broke ground 2023-09-01 on a 60MW masterplan across three campuses; rescoped 2024-03-08 to a 100MW first phase with a stated potential to 1GW; no later position held                                                                                                                                                                  | Baseline not held        |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Grid capacity against data-centre demand | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | About 3GW installed supply against a 10GW-by-2030 target; a single 1GW data centre would take a third of supply | Baseline not held |

## Technical Capacity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                           | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Kenya Advanced Institute of Science and Technology | KSh 2.3bn appropriated in FY2025/26 for continued construction at Konza | Charter issued and operationalisation under review with Korea Exim Bank; no FY2026/27 allocation disclosed and no commitment amount stated | <b>STALLED</b>    |
| Broadcast Logger and CA Broadcast Monitoring Room  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                | Nationwide deployment complete with a Broadcast Monitoring Room at the CA Centre                                                           | Baseline not held |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                   | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Cyber Space Management appropriation, Vote 1122              | No separately visible cyber appropriation                                                       | KSh 457.2m for Cyber Space Management appropriated in the original FY2026/27 estimates, plus KSh 382m for digital superhighway cybersecurity                                                                                                                   | <b>ADVANCED</b>   |
| Kenya Cyber Resilience Project                               | Did not exist                                                                                   | EUR 3m over 36 months, EU-funded, implemented by Expertise France with ESTDEV, hardening critical information infrastructure                                                                                                                                   | <b>ADVANCED</b>   |
| National Cyber Security Agency                               | Did not exist; cyber duties split across KE-CIRT/CC, NC4, law enforcement and sector regulators | Autonomous state corporation under the Interior Cabinet Secretary; mandate covers critical-infrastructure audit and certification, a National Cyber Security Operations Centre and incident coordination, at about KSh 4bn establishment cost                  | <b>ADVANCED</b>   |
| president.go.ke                                              | No compromise on record                                                                         | Second defacement inside twelve months, with a 5 BTC ransom demand; State House says no evidence of data access, and cause, access vector and attribution are undisclosed                                                                                      | <b>REGRESSED</b>  |
| Cyber threat events recorded by the communications regulator | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                        | 2.35 billion in the quarter to June 2026, chiefly web-application attacks; INTERPOL separately puts Kenya second on the continent for exploitable digital vulnerabilities detected in 2025 at 11.9%, behind South Africa at 43.6% and ahead of Nigeria at 9.1% | Baseline not held |

Three positions changed maturity band. Cyber-security acquired an institution: the National Cyber Security Agency Order was gazetted in May 2026 and announced approved in June, at a tabled establishment cost of about KSh 4bn, where cyber duties had previously been split across the regulator's incident team, a counter-terrorism centre, law enforcement and sector regulators. Satellite broadband flipped from decline to capacity exhaustion — from 17,425 subscribers and a shrinking share in mid-2025 to 24,999 and top-ten fixed status by March 2026, then closed sign-ups in seven counties and speeds down 26%. And the hyperscale anchor moved from build to stall, with the Olkaria facility missing its May 2026 launch and power established on the record as the constraint that stopped it.

Against that, the operational record moved the other way. The presidency's website went from no compromise on file to two defacements in twelve months, cause undisclosed both times. The Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act lost provisions to the courts rather than gaining reach. And the Konza data centre's appropriation disappeared from the estimates without explanation, having already fallen from KSh 5.2bn to KSh 3.1bn the year before.

Everything else accreted detail: a cloud region confirmed its host but has no launch date, a data centre broke ground then slipped six months, and the 100,000km fibre target was restated without a delivered-kilometre figure.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Advanced Cargo Declaration system                         | Did not exist            | In service, moving document lodgement and verification to before loading at the port of export; more than 1,000 applications in the first five days                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED          |
| Smart Gate, Port of Mombasa                               | Did not exist            | Piloting at one gate, integrating the Integrated Customs Management System with the systems of other government agencies; no cost, vendor, timetable or evaluation criterion published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED          |
| Digital Health (Data Exchange Component) Regulations 2025 | In force from 2025-04-11 | In force, designating the shared resources of the national health data exchange — the national health data dictionary, client registry, facility registry, health worker registry, the Kenya Health Enterprise Architecture and the national logistics management information system — as critical information infrastructure, and making onboarding and access to those registries fee-bearing; the Health Cabinet Secretary stated on 2026-08-04 that the charge is 2% of each transaction capped at KSh 5,000, payable to the Digital Health Agency | NO CHANGE         |
| KNPHI enterprise system interoperability baseline         | BASELINE NOT HELD        | IFMIS, central bank interfaces, tax, health insurance, pensions, government payroll, laboratory systems and identity management all made day-one mandatory interfaces, with primary hosting required in an approved Kenyan government or health-sector environment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Baseline not held |
| Pesalink and PAPSS interlink                              | BASELINE NOT HELD        | Links more than 80 Kenyan institutions to PAPSS, the first PAPSS national-switch pilot                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Baseline not held |

## Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Automatic identity at 18 from the civil register</b>        | Reform direction announced, with vetting shifted to birth registration                                                        | Statute mandates a civil-registration office in each of 290 sub-counties, with the unique personal identifier issued at birth feeding automatic identity at 18                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Maisha Namba national digital ID</b>                        | KSh 15.13bn committed FY2024/25 for 7.5m cards and unique personal identifier rollout; first-time-ID fees scrapped March 2025 | More than 42m identity records digitised in FY2025/26, with enrolment extended to dependants aged 7 to 17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Phone number as personal digital identifier</b>             | Not recognised in law                                                                                                         | Registered phone number recognised as a personal digital identifier, recycling of dormant numbers without consent barred, and the Attorney-General given six months to legislate; the window was still open as at 2026-08-12 with nothing tabled, and analysis of the judgment argues it should produce a coordinated number-recycling policy binding banks, savings societies and platforms that keep relying on numbers after reassignment | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Vote 1024 Population Management Services appropriation</b>  | KSh 8,085.6m appropriated in the FY2025/26 original estimates, KSh 11,074.0m at the first supplementary                       | KSh 10,993.0m appropriated for FY2026/27, holding near the supplementary peak                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Compulsory digital seller identifier</b>                    | Proposed by the trade ministry for e-commerce sellers                                                                         | Still a proposal, nothing on record being built                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Civil register link to police facial recognition</b>        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                      | Civil-registry database to be linked to a six-city CCTV and facial-recognition network                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Baseline not held        |
| <b>Digital birth-notification system</b>                       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                      | Hospital-to-registry notification linked to Maisha Namba, Nairobi County only                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Baseline not held        |
| <b>Electronic vehicle logbook</b>                              | Baseline not held                                                                                                             | The High Court issued a conservatory order barring the transport authority from discontinuing physical vehicle logbooks, pending a petition arguing the electronic logbook was introduced without public participation and without adequate data-protection and cybersecurity impact assessments; the electronic system stands but cannot replace the paper one while the order holds                                                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| <b>IEBC iris capture on voter-registration kits</b>            | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                      | Optional iris capture added to voter-registration kits as part of a roughly KSh 7bn upgrade                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Baseline not held        |
| <b>New identity and passport issuance system</b>               | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                      | Government procuring a system to cut identity-card issuance to ten days and passports to a week                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Baseline not held        |
| <b>Verifiable-credential wallet, Public Service Commission</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                      | Proof of concept completed after an audit found over 2,000 fake certificates; no single credential database                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Baseline not held        |

## Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Airtel Money Bizna Wallet</b>                   | Did not exist | Dedicated business wallet, free to fund, with half of transaction fees returned as in-wallet cashback, on a 10.9% mobile-money share         | ADVANCED |
| <b>Hustler Fund repayment through Bonga Points</b> | Did not exist | Five loyalty points settle one shilling — a privately issued loyalty balance converting into public-money recovery at a rate the issuer sets | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                              | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>M-PESA</b>                                       | 35.82m 30-day-active Kenyan customers at 31 March 2025, KES 161.1bn revenue, share slipping from about 98% | 40.99m 30-day-active Kenyan customers at 31 March 2026, KES 182.7bn revenue, KES 41.68tn transacted and 89.1% market share                       | ADVANCED          |
| <b>M-PESA business tariff schedule</b>              | Buy Goods fee-free to KES 200 and Pochi la Biashara fee-free to KES 100                                    | Buy Goods fee-free to KES 500, Pochi fee-free to KES 200 with fees capped for 90 days, and Pay to Mobile bands cut by up to 49.5%                | ADVANCED          |
| <b>M-PESA phone-number masking</b>                  | Masking limited to Pochi la Biashara                                                                       | Live on person-to-person transfers, with extension to merchant payments and bank transfers targeted for end-2026                                 | ADVANCED          |
| <b>My OneApp</b>                                    | Did not exist; M-PESA and mySafaricom were separate apps                                                   | Single front door to the payments rail, with the standalone apps to be decommissioned six months after launch                                    | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Registered mobile-money accounts and agents</b>  | 87.46m registered accounts and 451,157 active agents, August 2025                                          | 94.09m registered accounts and 564,330 active agents, May 2026, with agent cash movement of KSh 681.45bn in the month                            | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Ziidi Trader (M-PESA equity-trading service)</b> | Did not exist                                                                                              | Reportedly accounted for 40% of trades by number and 5% of daily trading value on the Nairobi Securities Exchange in its first days of operation | ADVANCED          |
| <b>CBK national switch and fast payment system</b>  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                   | Central bank designing a fast payment system and national switch amid heavy lobbying, with no award                                              | Baseline not held |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                   | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Online download of birth certificates</b> | Application online through eCitizen, collection required a visit to a registry or Huduma centre | Certificate downloadable and printable online after application                                                                                | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Ardhisasa land platform</b>               | Isiolo live, Mombasa Island blocks the prior week, Marsabit and Baringo named next              | No county-rollout update on file since July 2025; the EU has earmarked EUR 12m for land-registration digitisation tied to the digital identity | NO CHANGE |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Biometric Health Identification</b>               | Launched at Kenyatta University hospital 2025-08-04 with 29 biometric devices, operational in all level 4 to 6 public facilities | Extended to biometric enrolment of dependants aged 7 to 17, each issued a Maisha Namba linked to their health record | ADVANCED |
| <b>Kenya Education Management Information System</b> | Pilot due July 2025 and full go-live promised by September 2025, with a unique identifier for every child                        | No confirmation of go-live, coverage or learner count on file as at 2026-08-05                                       | STALLED  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Social Health Authority claims platform</b>           | Operational from October 2024; the Auditor-General found the KSh 104.9bn procurement unbudgeted and non-competitive, with intellectual property ceded to the consortium | Members turned away and billed in cash when authorisation fails, with the Authority saying the Digital Health Agency runs the system on its behalf           | REGRESSED         |
| <b>Digital Health Act 2023 and Digital Health Agency</b> | Binding statute in force establishing the Agency and an integrated digital health information system                                                                    | Same, with the 2025 regulations added, challenged in the High Court for inadequate public participation and operating under a Court of Appeal stay           | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Child Protection Information Management System</b>    | Baseline not held                                                                                                                                                       | Recorded cases rising from 20,235 (2016/17) to 54,583 (2021/22), credited with cutting duplication and improving real-time case coordination across agencies | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| <b>TaifaCare health management information system</b>    | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                       | Deployed in 1,500 public health facilities, against commitments of 2,000 by 2026, 4,000 by 2027 and 8,000 by 2028                                            | Baseline not held |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>2027 election technology appropriation</b>                 | Sh41.3bn allocated by the Treasury                                                                               | Sh74.8bn after Parliament approved Sh33.5bn in additional funding for 2027 election technology                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Digital Hubs Programme</b>                                 | 285 of 1,450 ward hubs completed                                                                                 | Reported at 588 committed Digital Hub sites nationwide against a target of one hub in every ward, with 46 Centres of Excellence and 40 Standard Digital Hubs under construction; procurement of 10,000 locally assembled desktops is complete for the first 100 pilot hubs, a further 10,000 under the Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project is in final stages and 2,222 Exchequer-funded machines are being acquired | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>eCitizen daily collections</b>                             | Under KSh 60m a day in the manual era, 2022                                                                      | KSh 600m a day                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>eCitizen platform</b>                                      | More than 20,000 e-services on the platform                                                                      | More than 22,000 services from over 100 agencies, with an expansion programme to 25,000 under way                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>eCitizen service-migration target</b>                      | 3,458 of 11,000 services onboarded in FY2024/25                                                                  | 1,695 of 11,000 onboarded to 31 March 2026, called a dismal performance; the 2023 Executive Order remains unmet                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | REGRESSED                      |
| <b>Kenya DPI Roadmap</b>                                      | Under development on five pillars, launched at the inaugural inter-ministerial steering committee                | No roadmap document, timetable or cost published; GIZ's Digital Transformation Centre Kenya has funded a work package inside the EU-EAC DEEP service contract to develop a bankable Kenyan DPI project                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED, AT PROCUREMENT STAGE |
| <b>Public Finance Management (e-Citizen) Regulations 2026</b> | Did not exist; a flat KSh 50 convenience fee was levied without regulations                                      | Draft before the public, replacing the flat fee with a value-pegged one after the High Court declared the KSh 50 illegal in late 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Vote 1024 e-Citizen Services appropriation</b>             | KSh 3,897.5m appropriated in the FY2025/26 original estimates, rising to KSh 5,585.9m at the first supplementary | KSh 3,612.6m appropriated for FY2026/27, the line's first decline after two years of growth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | REGRESSED                      |
| <b>e-Government Procurement system</b>                        | KSh 2,270m held through the FY2024/25 first supplementary, go-live scheduled July 2025                           | No post-go-live status, transaction volume or coverage figure on file                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | NO CHANGE                      |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                     | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>eCitizen operating consortium</b>                         | MPs seeking cancellation, the Attorney-General's signature missing from the contract, special audit not concluded | Contract still running; the Auditor-General alleges KSh 9.4bn irregularly funnelled to private entities and flags vendor dependency as a single point of failure | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>National Police Service Information Management System</b> | Design presented, consolidating fragmented police systems with role-based access and digital chain of custody     | No build, procurement or go-live status on file thirteen months later                                                                                            | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Diaspora information management portal</b>                | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                          | Live on eCitizen for diaspora registration, missing-person and death reporting, crisis mapping and a 24-hour response centre                                     | Baseline not held |
| <b>Kenya Ports Authority digitalisation</b>                  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                          | Bilateral commitment to technology transfer and digital solutions for Mombasa; no instrument, value or timetable                                                 | Baseline not held |

## Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>County digital services register</b>       | None published           | All 47 counties scored out of 100 on citizen experience, revenue and back-office systems, data use and employment creation, from 98.3 for Murang'a to 28.8 for Wajir, with seven counties at Grade A and six at Grade D | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Kirinyaga One Government Network fibre</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 102.4km of fibre connecting all five sub-counties, with nine public Wi-Fi hotspots live and 80 further sites surveyed                                                                                                   | Baseline not held |
| <b>Murang'a telemedicine network</b>          | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 170 public health facilities live and 302 more due before end-2026, with 15 doctors at a central hub handling 450 to 600 patients a day, from a 35-facility pilot at end-2025                                           | Baseline not held |

## National statistics

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                     | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>KNBS digital-indicator release</b>             | Economic Survey 2025, ICT chapter running to 2024 | Unchanged; the ICT chapter puts mobile subscriptions at 71.4m and 136.1 per 100 inhabitants in 2024, fixed and wireless internet subscriptions at 57.8m and mobile-money subscriptions at 42.3m, and no 2026 edition or Statistical Abstract is held | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Safaricom and KNBS mobile-data partnership</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                          | Collaboration to explore anonymised aggregated mobile data for population, mobility and socio-economic insight, with no scope, governance terms or start date                                                                                        | Baseline not held |

The identity and payments layers grew without changing band. Registered mobile-money accounts rose from 87.46 million to 94.09 million and active agents from 451,157 to 564,330; the dominant wallet went from 35.82 million to 40.99 million 30-day-active customers and moved KES 41.68tn in the year to March 2026. Identity records digitised passed 42 million. These are bigger numbers on the same systems.

What genuinely moved is legal and fiscal. A High Court ruling in March 2026 recognised a registered phone number as a personal digital identifier and barred recycling dormant numbers without consent, where no such recognition existed before; the civil-registration statute mandating an office in each of 290 sub-counties was assented; and birth certificates became downloadable online where collection had required a visit.

Two rows regressed. Service migration onto the government platform halved [against an unchanged 11,000-a-year target, from 3,458 to 1,695](#). And the platform's own appropriation fell for the first time after two years of growth, from KSh 3,897.5m in the 2025/26 original estimates [to KSh 3,612.6m for 2026/27](#), while the identity line rose to [KSh 10,993.0m](#).

Two systems stalled against their own stated dates: an education management information system promised a July 2025 pilot and a September 2025 go-live and has confirmed neither, and a police information system presented in July 2025 has no build or go-live status thirteen months later.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                   | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Access to Information (Amendment) Bill</b>           | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Would criminalise sharing classified information through personal messaging or email, on four classification tiers                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>AI Governance Act</b>                                | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Named in the draft policy as the statutory backstop, with no text, sponsor or date                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act 2018</b>         | In force with false-publication offences and a non-judicial website-shutdown power                              | Narrowed by litigation, with the false-publication sections and the shutdown power struck and a conservatory order blocking a national internet shutdown                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | REGRESSED |
| <b>Copyright and Related Rights Bill 2026</b>           | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Out for comment, creating a Copyright Authority and a disputes tribunal, and carrying the 2001 computer-generated-work authorship rule forward unchanged                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Kenya National Library Service Bill 2023</b>         | Published 2023-06-14 to repeal the Kenya National Library Service Act 1965, with no digital provision on record | At Senate committee hearing, with the ICT ministry asking that electronic legal deposit, a national digital knowledge repository, digital preservation of public records, AI-supported cataloguing and interoperability with government digital infrastructure be written into the Bill                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Sexual Offences Act amendment package</b>            | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Pre-parliamentary proposals on sextortion, stalking, voyeurism and AI-generated or altered intimate imagery, with an institutional duty to report                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Technopolis Act</b>                                  | Did not exist                                                                                                   | In force, giving innovation cities including Konza a standalone legal framework with a development authority and a disputes tribunal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Technopolis Regulations</b>                          | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Not finalised, with no draft on file                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025</b>         | Did not exist                                                                                                   | In force, with pre-existing operators given until 2026-11-04 to comply                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Virtual Asset Service Providers Regulations 2026</b> | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Gazetted as Legal Notice 134, with joint central bank and capital markets licensing across ten categories, capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for advisers, and a seizure and freezing framework; Binance, Luno, VALR, Yellow Card, Kotani Pay and Roqqu have said they intend to apply, and the regulators had not announced the application process as at 2026-08-07 | ADVANCED  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Cyber cafe customer registration and session logging rules    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Operators must capture each customer's name and identity number, the terminal used and session times, and retain the records at least three years, on pain of fines of up to 0.2% of annual turnover with a minimum of about US\$3,860. The regulator clarified on 2026-08-13 that the conditions do not require operators to track customers' browsing history. The licence conditions were published by gazette notice on 2026-08-07 and take effect on 2026-09-07 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| ICT Authority Bill                                            | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | On the forward legislative list with no text, sponsor or stage on file                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Kenya Information and Communications (Amendment) Bill 2025    | Baseline not held        | Before Parliament, proposing mandatory consumption-based internet billing; an internet service provider told the House the requirement could raise costs and create data-privacy risks, since metering consumption at subscriber level implies retaining usage records. No committee report, amendment schedule or enactment date is published                                                                                                                       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| Kenya Intellectual Property Bill                              | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Would merge three agencies into a new authority with an intellectual-property tribunal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Persons with Disabilities Act 2025                            | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In force but setting no AI accessibility standards and no enforcement mechanism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Repeal of the IEBC duty to livestream polling-station results | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Two bills would remove the commission's statutory duty to create a mechanism for livestreaming results from the polling station: the Elections (Amendment) Bill 2024, passed by the Senate in December 2024 and awaiting the National Assembly, and the Election Laws (Amendment) Bill 2026, sponsored jointly by the Senate majority and minority leaders. Neither is enacted                                                                                       | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Draft National Data Governance Policy               | Did not exist            | Draft of May 2026 schedules implementation from July 2026, with the personal and non-personal boundary undefined and the pricing method deferred                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Inter-Agency Digital Piracy Enforcement Framework   | Did not exist            | Adopted, with the ICT ministry coordinating the copyright board, the regulator, the Media Council and the Copyright Tribunal                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Joint Framework for Digital Platform Governance     | Did not exist            | In drafting, would replace safe-harbour immunity with earned protection and add a joint regulatory oversight committee                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Kenya Cloud Policy (2025) Implementation Guidelines | Did not exist            | 99 pages signed by the ICT Cabinet Secretary and covered dated June 2026, grading providers into four accreditation classes with a register published on the ministry website and a supplier-and-buyer marketplace administered by a Cloud Adoption Committee, and giving state organs 24 months to migrate non-exempted systems | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| National Policy on Digital Piracy                   | Did not exist            | Announced, to be drafted multi-stakeholder, with no draft, drafter or date                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Central bank pricing principles for mobile money    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Operating through voluntary operator alignment, with no gazetted tariff rule or determination to cite, appeal or extend to a competitor                                                                                                                                                                                          | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Harmonised county wayleave framework                | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Agreed to be developed and tabled at the intergovernmental sector forum, with no framework text, timetable, cost or wayleave figure published                                                                                                                                                                                    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT          | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                           | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| National BPO Policy           | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Claimed as delivered, with no text, adoption date or provisions on file | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| National Cloud Policy         | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Adopted, cited as anchoring domestic data-centre demand                 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| National Cybersecurity Policy | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | On the government's forward list with nothing drafted on record         | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                       | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                     | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Communications Equipment Vendor Class Licence guidelines   | Did not exist                                                                                     | In force, with a 12-month minimum warranty, returns, after-sales support and record-keeping duties              | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| ODPC quality management system                             | Did not exist                                                                                     | Quality management system launched with World Bank support, with the external certification audit still to come | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| ODPC draft guidance notes on biometric and children's data | Issued in draft, with mandatory registration of biometric processors and risk-based age assurance | Still in draft as far as the base establishes                                                                   | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| EU Global Gateway ICT standards engagement                 | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                          | Cooperation reaffirmed across AI, cybersecurity, digital identity, interoperability and digital governance      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                              | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Communications Authority escalated consumer complaints         | 362 complaints in October to December 2025 | 670 escalated complaints in April to June 2026, up from 563 in the prior quarter, with 548 or 82% resolved; data services drew 195 complaints against 44 for voice, data billing and charges was the largest single category at 75, and the Authority separately logged 19 data-breach complaints                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>REGRESSED</b> |
| Constitutional Petition E095 of 2026                           | Did not exist                              | Decided, awarding 11 petitioners KES 900,000 each for a sustained and systematic compromise of subscriber data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| Gambling regulator investigation into three licensed operators | Did not exist                              | Open, with the criminal investigations directorate requesting the regulator's entire record on the licensees back to 2018                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| ODPC Data Protection Services appropriation                    | No separately visible appropriation        | KSh 917.3m appropriated in the original estimates, projected to KSh 1,328m by 2028/29                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| ODPC Guidance Note on Artificial Intelligence                  | Did not exist                              | 36-page draft reading Part VI of the Data Protection Act onto AI, requiring a lawful transfer basis and a documented adequacy assessment before any transfer to an offshore AI processor, registration with the Office of every entity deploying AI on Kenyan data subjects' data, a data protection impact assessment before any high-risk deployment, and obligations mapped across a seven-stage AI lifecycle that applies to procured systems as to built ones | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| ODPC Guidance Note on Emerging Technologies                    | Did not exist                              | 31-page draft covering the internet of things, cloud, blockchain, biometric recognition classified as one-to-one, one-to-many and many-to-many, extended reality and connected vehicles                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| ODPC Guidance Note on Privacy-Enhancing Technologies           | Did not exist                              | 38-page draft reading adoption of privacy-enhancing technologies as a statutory obligation under privacy by design                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                                        | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>US-Kenya Health Cooperation Framework</b>             | Did not exist                                                                        | Signed 2025-12-04 for a five-year term, with US\$1,631,470,000 of planned United States support across FY2026-FY2030 including US\$175,000,000 for health data systems; frozen by injunction that month, the suspension of the data-transfer component reversed on appeal in May 2026, and a final ruling reported due at end-October 2026. The framework's US\$2.5bn headline value, used in press and litigation coverage, is this same US\$1,631,470,000 of planned US support plus Kenya's own pledged increase in domestic health expenditure (Framework paragraph 6.1.2, approximately US\$850m to FY2029/30 per the US Department of State's own announcement of the signing) – not a competing figure | ADVANCED                             |
| <b>Data Protection Act 2019</b>                          | In force, with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner as statutory regulator | In force, with the regulator now stretching its cross-border-transfer duties to reach offshore AI processing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | NO CHANGE                            |
| <b>ODPC enforcement caseload and penalties</b>           | 7,128 complaints received and 215 determinations issued as of March 2025             | Same statement; no later caseload, determination count or penalty total published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED |
| <b>ODPC five-year privacy plan</b>                       | Launched at KES 12.6bn over five years                                               | Launched, with no spend, milestone or progress statement on file since                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | NO CHANGE                            |
| <b>Betting and gaming firms registered with the ODPC</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                             | 15 of 224 fully registered as both controller and processor, with 185 unregistered and given 40 days or licence cancellation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Baseline not held                    |
| <b>Cybercrime losses, regulator estimate</b>             | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                             | At least KSh 29bn a year                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Baseline not held                    |

## Open data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT             | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>National data marketplace</b> | Did not exist | Proposed state-run marketplace, more than 1,000 datasets over five years, KSh 396m to build and operate, overseen by a proposed national council | ADVANCED |

The clearest band change in this report is here. Virtual assets went from no statute at all to an Act commenced in November 2025, gazetted regulations in July 2026 with capital set by licence class, a seizure and freezing framework, and a hard compliance deadline of 4 November 2026. Artificial intelligence went from one strategy to four instruments – a 226-page draft policy, a Senate bill on a separate track, draft regulator guidance reaching offshore processing through transfer rules, and a costed-but-unfunded strategy – and not one of them is binding.

Enforcement capacity became visible in the estimates for the first time: Data Protection Services received KSh 917.3m in the 2026/27 original estimates, where through 2025/26 the regulator had no separately visible line. What this base cannot yet show is what that capacity produced: the regulator's caseload bulletin and its statutory register of data handlers are both published and both unheld.

The Data Protection Act itself was not amended. What accumulated on top of it is enforcement episodes, litigation and third-party analysis: a constitutional petition decided in May 2026 [awarding eleven petitioners KES 900,000 each for a sustained and systematic compromise of subscriber data](#), a 40-day registration ultimatum to 224 betting firms of which 15 were fully registered, and an investigation opened into three licensed operators. The one instrument that lost reach did so through the courts.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>ATLAS Umoja AI</b>                                       | Did not exist                                                                 | Kenya one of five governments pooling datasets and research to scale an open-source African-language template                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Kenya AI and Other Emerging Technologies Policy 2026</b> | None published, no national AI policy instrument                              | 226-page draft out for consultation, with a risk-based lifecycle model, effects-based extraterritorial reach, binding AI-worker standards and a disclosure duty; high risk undefined and penalties unstated. A civil-society submission of 2026-08-14 urges institutional independence for the proposed AI council and mandatory human-rights impact assessments, and a separate account puts the draft as nearing Cabinet consideration | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Kenya Artificial Intelligence Bill 2026</b>              | Did not exist                                                                 | Before the Senate, a self-declared EU AI Act transplant with a presidentially appointed commissioner and fines capped at KES 5m                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Kenya-Germany applied AI centre</b>                      | Did not exist                                                                 | Centre of African Excellence for Applied AI proposed, still at preliminary-consultation stage with no formalised agreement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Konza Digital Media City and AI data centre</b>          | Digital Media City financing agreement signed 2023, no AI data-centre element | Proposed Digital Media City plus an AI data centre at Konza, with a delegation expected August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>National AI computing platform</b>                       | None published                                                                | To be established at the Technopolis Development Authority with GPU infrastructure, serving researchers, universities and startups                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>National AI Strategy 2025-2030</b>                       | In force, no implementation roadmap, costing or budget line held              | Roadmap published with an 80% 5G population-coverage target by 2030, costed at KSh 152bn over five years with no dedicated allocation in the FY2026/27 budget                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Servernah Cloud</b>                                      | Did not exist                                                                 | Marketed as Kenya's first sovereign-hosted cloud and AI platform, running AI workloads without sending data offshore                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Safaricom automated decisioning and Zuri</b>             | AI deployed in fraud detection and customer service, no challenge on file     | Chatbot and automated M-PESA decisioning still operating; the petition alleges no guaranteed route to a human agent, no disclosure of decision logic and algorithmic discrimination in credit scoring                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | NO CHANGE, NOW UNDER CHALLENGE |
| <b>Absa Kenya AI policy and Citrus agent</b>                | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                      | Bank adopted its own AI policy during 2025, with a proprietary AI agent piloting for deepfake detection at account opening                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Baseline not held              |
| <b>Adult monthly use of an AI tool</b>                      | Baseline not held                                                             | 97.5% of online adults reported using an artificial-intelligence tool monthly, ranked first globally ahead of the United Arab Emirates at 94.2% and Indonesia at 93.6%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>       |
| <b>Bank use of AI in credit risk assessment</b>             | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                      | Nearly 45% of commercial banks using artificial intelligence in credit risk assessment, on a Central Bank of Kenya figure                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Baseline not held              |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17         | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| Content-moderation and annotation redundancies | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 1,108 Kenyan jobs cut | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT   | AT 2025-08-01                                                      | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Qubit Hub              | Did not exist                                                      | African AI research and development lab to be hosted at iXAfrica NBOX1 on sovereign compute                                                                        | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Startup funding raised | US\$1.04bn raised in 2025, first in Africa and up 72% year on year | US\$126m total and US\$46m equity in the first half of 2026, third in Africa and the weakest half since early 2021                                                 | <b>REGRESSED</b>         |
| Vumah Labs             | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                           | Two named products, one for detecting falsified content and verifying digital media and one for consent management                                                 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Zerobionics            | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                           | Kenyan-built humanoid robots rendering speech into sign language in real time, with recycled-plastic casing cutting costs by over 60% and delivery working over 2G | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                          | AT 2026-08-17                                                                 | MOVEMENT         |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| OpenAI Academy Nairobi                        | Did not exist                                                                          | Proposal for East Africa's first OpenAI Academy, unsigned                     | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| Safaricom and AWS generative AI collaboration | Collaboration for fraud detection, customer-service automation and engineer upskilling | Unchanged, with no expansion, spend figure or workload detail published since | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Kenya-China e-commerce cooperation memorandum                    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Cited as the basis for a delegation to the Silk Road e-commerce matching activity, framed inside the Digital Master Plan                                                                                                                                              | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Talks with a Chinese network group on broadband and smart cities | <i>Baseline not held</i> | The ICT principal secretary received a delegation from a Chinese network communications group to explore investment in broadband, smart cities and digital infrastructure, building on work at the technopolis; no memorandum, commitment, value or project is stated | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                       | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                       | MOVEMENT        |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Kenya-India-Italy sovereign AI partnership | Did not exist | Targets 100 AI-deployment programmes by 2030 on multilingual low-bandwidth voice AI | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

At the window's opening this section had infrastructure and no state instrument: a [US\\$1bn data-centre announcement already known to be slipping](#), one sovereign-cloud product, a cloud region that was a two-year-old announcement, and no Kenyan artificial-intelligence policy, bill, guidance or costing of any kind.

The regulatory layer filled in across the year, as set out above. The domestic sovereign-cloud layer also moved from a single vendor announcement to a working stack on one campus — a second platform launched in March 2026, a third in May, and a research lab announced the same month — while the cloud region selected its host but did not launch.

The patron layer accreted announcements without delivery. Four bilateral channels opened or were restated across the year, and none has a delivery, budget or date attached. Funding regressed sharply, from first in Africa on US\$1.04bn in 2025 [to third on US\\$126m in the first half of 2026](#). And the labour underside entered the record in both directions in the same year: [1,108 redundancies in April when a moderation contract ended](#), and a draft policy in July that would regulate that same workforce.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming</b> | In delivery, including work in remote counties                                                                                                                   | Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named                                                       | REGRESSED         |
| <b>KenSafeSpace</b>                                                   | Running on a EUR 1.3m EU grant                                                                                                                                   | Closed after 30 months, reporting 18,000 reached directly, 9.4m through campaigns and 133 defenders trained, with a 49-member coalition continuing unfunded | CLOSED            |
| <b>Smartphone against feature-phone connections</b>                   | 48.7m smartphone and 29.6m feature-phone connections, December 2025                                                                                              | 50.2m smartphone connections, above 50m for the first time, with feature phones down to 28.5m                                                               | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Enhancing Digital Access and Community Resilience</b>              | GBP 2.3m committed, activities starting late 2025                                                                                                                | GBP 2.3m across eight arid-lands counties including refugee-hosting Garissa and Turkana, with no completion report held                                     | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Universal Service Fund</b>                                         | 20 sub-locations connected in FY2024/25 and 155 cumulatively, reaching about 508,012 people, with construction started at 32 of 47 planned centres of excellence | Unchanged; no FY2025/26 account published                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>EmpowerHer</b>                                                     | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                | Targets 15,000 women across three counties on a trainer-of-trainers model, with no value or reach-to-date disclosed                                         | Baseline not held |

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                               | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Starlink school connectivity with GrowX and CEMASTE A</b> | Did not exist                               | 30 schools across 30 districts reaching more than 32,000 students and about 1,000 teachers, with financial terms undisclosed | ADVANCED  |
| <b>EU Last Mile Connectivity of Schools</b>                  | EUR 9.8m committed                          | Commitment unchanged, with no outturn published                                                                              | NO CHANGE |
| <b>EU-UNICEF school connectivity</b>                         | EUR 9.8m committed to connect 1,000 schools | Commitment unchanged, with no disbursement or schools-connected update published                                             | NO CHANGE |
| <b>UK Digital Access Programme, Kenya</b>                    | GBP 4.77m committed                         | Commitment unchanged, with no outturn published                                                                              | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Adult formal financial inclusion | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 83.7% of adults, against 26.7% in 2006                                                                                                       | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Fuliza overdraft disbursement    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Record KSh 1.4tn disbursed, with the repayment-to-disbursement ratio flat year on year                                                       | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Hustler Fund                     | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | KSh 83bn disbursed against KSh 71bn recovered, with state funding down from KSh 20bn at launch to KSh 300m in the year to June 2026          | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Hustler Fund default rate        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 15% default, about KSh 12.5bn; the Auditor-General found 104,631 loans worth KSh 116.5m issued to borrowers with no identity details on file | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Literacy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                        | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Digital Literacy Programme          | 1,170,846 digital devices installed in 22,891 public primary schools and 216 schools connected to the internet, on the 2022 review's milestone table | Unchanged; no device, school or learning-outcome figure published since 2022                                | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| Regulator school computer donations | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                             | 23 educational institutions supported recently, with no quantity, value or connectivity provision disclosed | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Safaricom Hook Circle               | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                             | Over one million young people reached across six counties                                                   | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                  | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| HerSpace                                                | Did not exist                                  | Training 150 justice-sector officials on digital evidence, with no value disclosed                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Mastercard Foundation EdTech Fellowship                 | Eight-month cohorts for growth-stage companies | Cohort 4 runs 18 months for early-stage companies, offering each up to US\$100,000 in equity-free funding and scoped to learners with disabilities, refugee and rural communities, and girls and young women; 36 Kenyan companies since the 2023 launch, on iHUB's figures | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| EU digitalisation of technical and vocational education | EUR 9.9m committed                             | Commitment unchanged, with no outturn published                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| KfW digitalisation of vocational training               | EUR 18m concessional loan committed            | Commitment unchanged, with no disbursement published                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| KfW promotion of vocational training in ICT             | EUR 5m concessional loan                       | Commitment unchanged, with the scheduled end year reached and no closure statement held                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| Jitume Digital Enablement Programme                     | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                       | 117 hubs commissioned on the ceremony series and about 350 on the installed-base series                                                                                                                                                                                    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Jitume training throughput                              | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                       | More than 140,000 young people trained and more than 41,000 linked to economic opportunity since 2023                                                                                                                                                                      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

One programme closed and one opened. The digital-rights coalition ended in July 2026 after 30 months; a successor training programme began the same day. An arid-lands access programme passed its scheduled March 2026 completion with no completion report on file.

Six donor instruments held position all year at their original commitment values because the base holds commitments and no disbursement for any of them. That is not a finding about the programmes; it is a finding about what is published.

The measured positions moved modestly and in one direction. Smartphone connections passed 50 million in March 2026 from 48.7 million in December 2025, with feature phones falling to 28.5 million. The flagship lending fund's repayment is now accepted in a privately issued loyalty currency at a rate the issuer sets.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Atlas Tower Kenya debt facility (ATK Debt II)                 | Did not exist                                                 | US\$25m IFC debt inside a US\$30m multi-currency debt package financing new macro towers and expanded mobile network capacity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED          |
| EBRD-Axian Telecom (Yas) senior loan financing, Kenya tranche | Did not exist                                                 | EUR270m total facility across 21 obligors in 8 jurisdictions; committed facility up to EUR170m includes a local-currency tranche of up to EUR20m equivalent in Kenyan shillings funding fibre-infrastructure modernisation in Kenya, plus an uncommitted EUR100m facility for future acquisitions and capex across EBRD's sub-Saharan African countries of operation | ADVANCED          |
| IFC Catalytic First Loss Guarantee transactions               | Did not exist                                                 | US\$24.2m committed across three Kenyan lenders with US\$11m of IDA Private Sector Window backing, expected to catalyse about US\$144.4m in local-currency lending to micro-enterprises                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED          |
| Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project                    | KSh 3.7bn in the FY2025/26 estimates on a US\$390m commitment | KSh 4.3bn appropriated for FY2026/27, half the entire digital thematic, equipping more than 10,000 junior secondary schools                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED          |
| Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project disbursement       | BASELINE NOT HELD                                             | US\$33.93m disbursed of US\$390m committed, in year three of an operation closing October 2028                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Baseline not held |

### MoUs and other agreements

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT         | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-17                                                             | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| EU-Kenya Digital Partnership | BASELINE NOT HELD | KSh 15.3bn committed, including EUR 37m to the Blue Raman submarine cable | Baseline not held |

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Digital economy and creative industry thematic allocation   | KSh 12.7bn for FY2025/26                 | KSh 8.6bn for FY2026/27, a second consecutive cut from KSh 16.3bn in FY2024/25                                           | REGRESSED         |
| Vote 1122, State Department for ICT and the Digital Economy | KSh 16,188.8m appropriated for FY2025/26 | KSh 12,763.8m appropriated for FY2026/27, with FY2025/26 itself revised down to KSh 12,215.1m at the first supplementary | REGRESSED         |
| Digital hubs establishment appropriation                    | BASELINE NOT HELD                        | KSh 400m appropriated for establishing digital hubs                                                                      | Baseline not held |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| FY2027/28 budget process                                | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Digital Superhighway named a priority sector, with no ceiling, figure or timetable published | Baseline not held |
| Last-mile county connectivity maintenance appropriation | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | KSh 528m appropriated for maintenance and rehabilitation                                     | Baseline not held |

State financing fell while the externally financed share rose. The digital thematic allocation went KSh 16.3bn, KSh 12.7bn, KSh 8.6bn across three years, and the World Bank acceleration project rose to KSh 4.3bn — half the entire thematic — [having disbursed US\\$33.93m of a US\\$390m commitment by June 2026](#). The department's own vote fell from KSh 16,188.8m appropriated for 2025/26 to [KSh 12,763.8m for 2026/27, with the intervening year revised down to KSh 12,215.1m](#).

State funding for the flagship lending fund fell from KSh 20bn at launch to KSh 300m in the year to June 2026.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | LAST PROBED |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| CA spectrum-interference audit, direct-to-cell        | a published CA determination or gazette notice would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, no CA determination or gazette notice on interference published; trade reporting only                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2026-08-05  |
| Data-centre power tariff or grid-connection framework | a published EPRA or Kenya Power data-centre tariff, or a gazetted large-load connection rule, would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, EPRA tariffs and open-access regulations carry no data-centre category and no large-load connection rule                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2026-08-05  |
| National earth-observation data programme             | a Kenya Space Agency strategy or national earth-observation data policy would settle it; every satellite-data source the place holds is continental or vendor-side; probed 2026-08-05, KSA Strategic Plan 2023-2027 located; the EO Data Sharing Framework 2026 itself is a landing page only                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2026-08-05  |
| Registered data controllers and processors            | the ODPC register or its annual report would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, the statutory register is public and live; a total needs pagination traversal, not a single fetch                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2026-08-05  |
| Installed AI compute capacity                         | no held source states Kenya's installed GPU or accelerator capacity; a ministry or regulator inventory would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, no ministry or regulator inventory exists; the nearest official statement is a Konza transaction document giving 0.7MW IT capacity, 144 racks and no dedicated GPU clusters; on ingest the Konza transaction document proved to be dated 2026-04-13, not 2020, so its 0.7MW / 144-rack / no-GPU-cluster statement is current rather than historical | 2026-08-05  |
| Ajira Digital Programme                               | the state's other flagship digital-work programme is effectively absent from the base; probed 2026-08-05, no official programme report retrievable and ajiradigital.go.ke renders only a broken interface; an SSRN case study is the only first-hand document reached                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2026-08-05  |

Nothing in the gaps table moved during the period, which is itself the point: a universal service fund with no levy rate or accounts on file, a digital literacy programme with no device or school count, and a regulator's enforcement record that has never been published are absences of the same age as the window. They are the first briefs for the country-deep sweep.

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.